



PHOTOS COURTESY **MICHELLE SOLE, QUARK EXPEDITIONS**

earlier planning cycle, and a much higher conversion rate for niche markets such as the Arctic and Antarctica,” she says.

The shift accelerated after the pandemic, when travelers began prioritising journeys that felt meaningful rather than routine. The polar regions, with their remoteness and strict visitor regulations, represent the ultimate version of what luxury travel has become: rare, difficult to access,

and emotionally transformative.

“It’s not just about reaching Antarctica; it’s about how you experience it, interpret it, and carry it with you,” Kohli says. For travel companies, this means building journeys around the expedition itself, including pre-journey preparation, private extensions and curated experiences.

THE COST

Polar travel is expensive, and that

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THE ANTARCTIC:

***Pocket Pinch: \$19,995**
per person for 8 days

***Best Time to Visit:**
November to March

THE ARCTIC:

***Pocket Pinch: \$10,200** per
person for 11 days

***Best Time to Visit:**
May to July